

CORRIDOR DNA

Understand a place at a glance.

BEGINNER → INTERMEDIATE DATA + VISUALIZATION OPTIONAL: MAP / LLM / MCP

THE IDEA

Imagine someone asks: “What is this corridor like?” Instead of making them search through many different pieces of data, you could build a simple profile for that corridor - a quick “DNA” card for the place.

THE QUESTION TO SOLVE “Can we turn many data points about a corridor into one clear picture of the place?”

WHAT SHOULD THE PROFILE ANSWER?

- What kind of place is this?
- Who is associated with it?
- When is it more active?
- What kinds of places and anchors are already there?
- What business formats appear to fit?

THE MINDSET You are not trying to show everything in the dataset. You are choosing the information that helps someone understand the place quickly.

EXAMPLE 02 / UNDERSTAND THE PROBLEM

1. WHY WOULD SOMEONE NEED THIS?

The corridor data contains many different kinds of information. Each piece can be useful on its own, but the real value comes from putting the pieces together.

Data by itself	What does this tell me?
Character + audiences	What kind of place is this, and who is it for?
Activity + places	When is it active, and what is around it?
All of the above	Can I understand the corridor in one minute?

2. START WITH ONE SIMPLE QUESTION

START HERE “What should I know about this corridor before making a decision about it?”

A first version can simply take one corridor and show its most useful information. Once that works, you can make the profile more interactive or intelligent.

3. A SIMPLE WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT

Choose a corridor	Understand its character	See who + when	See what is around it	Show the bigger picture
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KEEP IT SIMPLE The first version does not need AI. Read the corridor data, pick useful information, organize it and present it clearly.

4. WHAT COULD THE USER SEE?

A useful profile might have five simple sections: Character • Who is here? • When is it active? • What is already there? • What business formats fit?

EXAMPLE 02 / USE THE DATA

5. WHICH PARTS OF THE DATA CAN HELP?

Character	A plain-English description of the corridor, its neighborhoods and the type of place it is.
Audience	The groups associated with the corridor. The dataset includes 55 audience segments, such as morning commuters, family households, office routines and study groups.
Activity	Information about different parts of the day, such as morning, midday, evening, late night and weekend activity.
Places	Existing places around the corridor, such as cafés, grocery stores, schools, hospitals, event venues and nightlife.
Anchors / special context	Important places or activity magnets that help explain why a corridor behaves the way it does.
Business fit	Information about which business formats appear more or less suitable for the corridor.

6. YOU DO NOT NEED EVERYTHING

A common mistake is trying to put every field on the screen. Start with the information that answers the user’s question.

GOOD FIRST VERSION Character + top audiences + activity by time + a few important places + business-fit highlights

Then add more only when it makes the profile more useful.

7. WHAT IS A “BUSINESS FORMAT”?

A business format - sometimes called an “archetype” in the dataset - simply means a particular type of business setup. For example, the data may distinguish between different kinds of cafés designed for different environments.

EASY WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT “What type of business seems to make sense in this kind of place?”

EXAMPLE 02 / BUILD THE PROFILE

8. WHAT COULD A CORRIDOR DNA PROFILE LOOK LIKE?

The exact design is up to you. The goal is to make the important information easy to scan.

CORRIDOR DNA CORRIDOR A • NYC A mixed-use corridor with strong residential and evening activity.	
WHO IS HERE? Residents  Commuters  Families  Workers 	WHEN IS IT ACTIVE? Morning  Midday  Evening  Weekend 
WHAT IS AROUND IT? Cafés • Grocery Schools • Events Transit • Other places	BUSINESS FIT Format A STRONG Format B STRONG Format C MODERATE

9. WHAT MAKES THIS USEFUL?

A good profile should help a user understand the corridor without reading the raw JSON.

- Show the important information first.
- Use simple charts or bars when they make comparison easier.
- Keep the number of sections manageable.
- Explain what the information means instead of only showing numbers.

A GOOD TEST Could someone understand the character of this corridor in about one minute?

EXAMPLE 02 / BUILD IN LEVELS

10. BUILD A SMALL VERSION FIRST

LEVEL 1 / BEGINNER

Pick one corridor → read its data → show the most useful information → make a clean profile.

LEVEL 2 / INTERMEDIATE

Add charts, a map, more filters, corridor comparisons or clickable detail sections.

LEVEL 3 / ADVANCED

Let users ask questions in plain English and use an LLM + MCP to collect and explain the relevant data.

11. WHERE COULD MCP FIT?

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a way for an AI model to use tools or data sources in a structured way. For this example, it could sit between the user’s question and your corridor data.

User asks	AI understands	MCP gets the data	Your logic organizes it	Answer + explanation
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For example, the AI could ask for the corridor details, audience information, business-fit information and places, then use those results to create a short profile.

REMEMBER MCP is the bridge. The useful product is the clear answer the user gets from the data.

EXAMPLE 02 / MAKE IT MORE USEFUL

12. YOU CAN MAKE THE PROFILE INTERACTIVE

Once the basic profile works, think about what a real user might ask next.

COMPARE	“How is Corridor A different from Corridor B?”
AUDIENCE	“Which corridor is more relevant for families?”
ACTIVITY	“Which corridors are strongest in the evening?”
BUSINESS	“Which business formats appear strongest here?”
SEARCH	“Show me corridors with strong residential activity and weekend activity.”

13. POSSIBLE EXTENSIONS

- Create a profile card for every corridor in the dataset.
- Add side-by-side comparison between two corridors.
- Add a map so users can explore corridors geographically.
- Generate a short written summary of each corridor with an LLM.
- Allow natural-language questions instead of only buttons and filters.
- Create downloadable one-page corridor reports.

THE IMPORTANT PART Each extension should make the profile more useful to someone making a decision - not just make it

more complicated.

14. WHAT COULD THE FINAL PRODUCT BE?

It does not have to be a dashboard. It could be a website, mobile view, report generator, comparison tool, map, or AI-powered analyst. The format is up to you.

EXAMPLE 02 / PRODUCT THINKING

15. THINK FROM THE USER'S PERSPECTIVE

Do not start with: “What charts can I make?” Start with: “What does someone need to know about this place?”

USER	Business team, researcher, analyst or entrepreneur
QUESTION	What kind of place is this?
EVIDENCE	Character + audience + activity + places + business fit
OUTPUT	A clear profile that can be understood quickly
DECISION	What should I investigate or compare next?

16. WHAT NOT TO DO

- Do not copy every field from the JSON onto the screen.
- Do not make a chart just because the data allows it.
- Do not present an AI-generated description as fact if the data does not support it.
- Do not make the interface more complicated than the question needs.

BETTER APPROACH Pick the user. Pick the question. Then choose only the data that helps answer it.

17. IMPORTANT DATA NOTE

The dataset contains useful signals, but some information is based on expert or contextual assessment rather than direct measurement. Daypart information should be treated as relative activity indicators, not exact visitor counts. Business-fit information is a guide, not a guarantee of success.

USE CAREFUL LANGUAGE “This corridor shows strong signals for...” is better than “This corridor will succeed for...”

EXAMPLE 02 / YOUR CHALLENGE

18. YOUR CHALLENGE

BUILD THIS IDEA IN YOUR OWN WAY Create a simple tool that answers:

“What should I know about this corridor before making a decision about it?”

Start with one corridor. Decide what information is useful. Turn it into a clear profile. Then decide how much further you want to take it.

YOU DECIDE

- What information the profile should show.
- How you want to visualize it.
- Who your target user is.
- What decision the profile should support.
- Whether you want to add maps, AI, MCP or other features.

19. REMEMBER

START SMALL A clean profile with five useful sections is better than a complicated product that nobody can understand.

THEN EXTEND Once the basic profile is useful, add comparisons, maps, questions, AI or other features.

STAY GROUNDED Your conclusions should come from the data you were given. Be clear about what is measured, what is estimated and what is your own interpretation.

QUESTION → DATA → CLEAR PROFILE → USEFUL DECISION

Start with one useful answer. Then build from there.